



Aasha Tours

TRAVEL BULLETIN

WHAT CHANGED THIS MONTH, AND WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOUR NEXT TRIP



THIS MONTH

Sri Lanka, in *nine days*

Three climates, one short flight, and nine days that do not feel rushed. Page 2.

WHY USE A TRAVEL AGENT

No. 1 of a series

A portal takes your money and stops there. It did not tell anyone that Thailand halved the stay last month, or that a British visa may no longer open Dubai. Rules move after you have paid. Someone has to be watching them. That is what you are really buying.

— Ankit Sisodia

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Three climates, one short flight, and nine days that work.

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The Maldives, Japan in snow, and Bali in its quietest weeks.

4 What changed this month

Thailand halves the stay. The UAE tightens. Europe drops a visa.

5 Hotels and the corporate desk

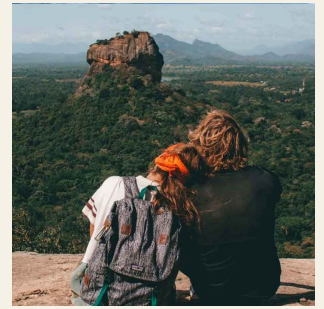
India's #2 resort, and two January exhibitions in Frankfurt and Dubai.

Know your destination: Sri Lanka

PLAN IT WITH US

Three climates. One short flight. Nine days that do not feel rushed.

A country the size of a large Indian state, with leopards, tea hills, Dutch ramparts and a coastline, all within a few hours of each other. No internal flights, no long transfers, no jet lag. You land before lunch and are on a beach by evening.



WHEN TO GO

December to March. The dry season across the south coast, the west coast and the hill country — the lowest rainfall and the most sunshine of the year, and the one window when the beaches, the tea estates and the parks are all good at once.



NINE DAYS, IN ORDER

Nine days, one loop, no backtracking. The south coast for the fort and the sea, Yala for the leopards, the hill country by train through the tea, and Sigiriya for the climb. Three landscapes, a car and driver throughout, and nothing booked that you have to rush.

DAYS 1-2 Arrive, drive south

Straight down the coast road. Nobody should spend a holiday in Colombo.

DAYS 3-4 Galle and the south coast

The Dutch fort at dusk, whales off Mirissa, the beaches at Unawatuna.

DAYS 5-6 Yala or Wilpattu

Leopard country. Yala has the density; Wilpattu has the space.

DAYS 7-8 The hill country

The train from Kandy to Ella through the tea estates.

DAY 9 The Cultural Triangle

Sigiriya at first light, the cave temples at Dambulla on the way back.



DO NOT MISS

- Galle Fort at dusk, walked, not driven
- The Kandy-Ella train through the tea country
- Sigiriya at opening, before the heat
- A leopard at Yala, with a tracker who knows the park

YOURS, NOT OFF A SHELF

This is a shape, not a package. We build every Sri Lanka trip around who is travelling — slower with young children, longer in the hills for a honeymoon, the whole thing compressed into seven days if that is all you have. Tell us what you want and we will redraw it.

HOW WE HELP Tell us who is travelling and when. We come back with a plan, the hotels to match it, and one price — not a list of things to book yourself. [Connect now](#)

Seasonal pattern per Intrepid Travel's Sri Lanka guide

Three places worth choosing for the season ahead. **The last is in its quietest, cheapest weeks of the year.**

WHY NOW · THE YEAR'S FINEST CONDITIONS

The Maldives

You can see thirty metres down. For about four weeks.

Mid dry season — flat water, clear skies, the best diving of the year. The villa categories sell out long before the flights do.

What I'll do: hold the villa category you want, and the seaplane slot with it, then build the ticket around it.

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WHY NOW · THE ONE MONTH IT LOOKS LIKE THIS

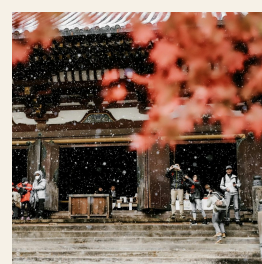
Japan in snow

The Japan in the photographs. It only looks like that now.

Niseko and Hakuba in full powder. Kyoto's temples under snow, the autumn crowds gone.

What I'll do: book the ryokan with the private onsen while it is still open, and route you to lose a connection, not a day.

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WHY NOW · LEAN SEASON, HONESTLY

Bali

Everyone else goes in July. They are paying for the privilege.

January is the wet season — rain in short afternoon bursts, not all-day grey. The terraces are green, the crowds are gone, and the villas you cannot get in July are open.

What I'll do: book a villa with its own pool so an afternoon shower costs you nothing, and keep the touring to mornings.

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WANT THE NUMBERS?

Rates move weekly, which is why there are no prices on this page. Send your dates and how many are travelling and we come back with a real costing, not a range.

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Four changes worth knowing before you book. **Every one checked against a named source this month.**

Thailand: sixty days became thirty

The rule changed on 15 September. Your plan probably has not.

Thailand's Royal Gazette cut visa-free entry for Indian passports from 60 days to 30, effective 15 September. A further 30 days is possible, but only at the discretion of the immigration officer on the day — never assume it.

HOW WE HELP we check the stay against your dates before you book, not at Suvarnabhumi.

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Business Standard, 2 September 2026, on the Royal Gazette notification

UAE: a British visa alone may not be enough

Turned away at the gate, on a ticket already paid for.

Under updated UAE guidelines, Indian passport holders whose only qualifying document is a UK visa or residence permit are reported to have lost visa-on-arrival. US and EU visa holders are unaffected.

HOW WE HELP send us the passport and we file the UAE visa before you fly.

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Business Standard, 1 July 2026, reporting ICP guidelines

Europe: the transit visa quietly disappeared

One less form, if you are only changing planes.

Spain, France and Germany have each dropped the airport transit visa for Indian nationals connecting on to a non-EU destination — Spain from 4 March, France 10 April, Germany 3 June. It applies to transit, not entry, so the routing matters.

HOW WE HELP we build the connection through a country where the rule applies, so you are not applying for a visa you no longer need.

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Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India

Been to Europe twice? Stop applying for single entry

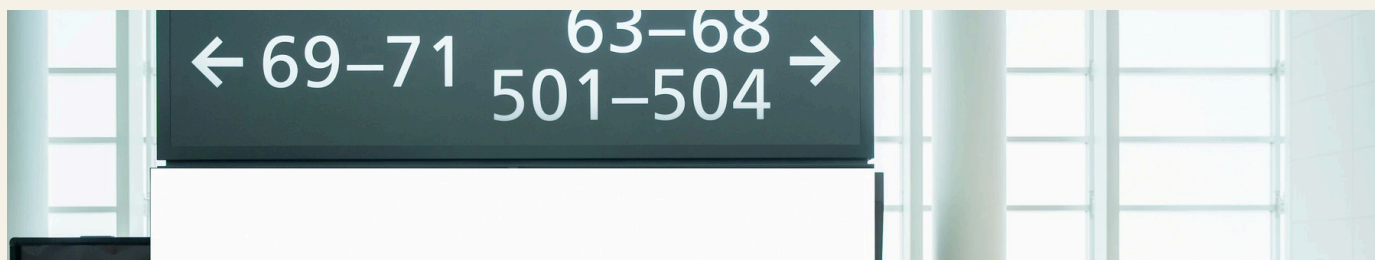
One form. Two years of Europe. Same fee as a single trip.

Two Schengen visas used within three years qualifies you for a two-year multi-entry, then usually a five-year. Most people never ask.

FREE CHECK send us the visa pages of your old passports and we tell you if you qualify. No charge, no obligation.

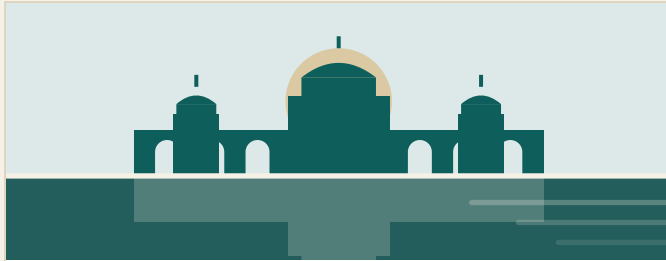
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EU Delegation to India



Two hotels worth the journey

EXCLUSIVE STAYS

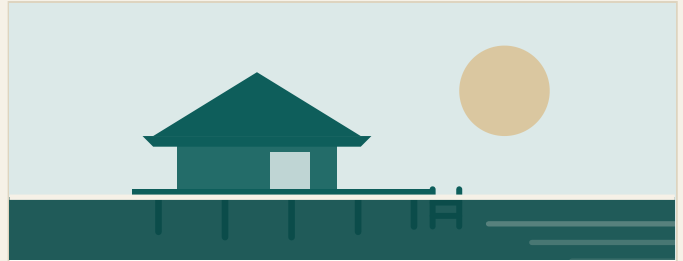


IN INDIA

The Leela Palace Udaipur

#2 Resort in India • Top 100 Hotels in the World

Travel + Leisure's 2026 World's Best Awards, voted by 207,000 travellers, placed it second among all Indian resorts. Twenty minutes from our desk.



IN THE WORLD

Waldorf Astoria Maldives Ithaafushi

#9 in the Top 100 Hotels in the World

Eleven dining rooms, a private-island residence, every villa with its own pool — and January is the Maldives at its best.

HOW WE HELP At the Leela the lake-view and palace suites are the constraint, not rooms generally.

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Travel + Leisure, World's Best Awards 2026. Illustrations, not photographs of the properties.

For the corporate desk

JANUARY EXHIBITIONS

Two majors, both in January. **A Schengen appointment booked in December is a January trip you do not take.**

12-15 JANUARY 2027

Heimtextil

Messe Frankfurt • Germany

The world's largest home and contract textiles fair. For the Bhilwara mills, and for any hotel buying furnishings — it covers the hospitality contract trade too.

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25-28 JANUARY 2027

WHX Dubai

Dubai Exhibition Centre • UAE

Formerly Arab Health, and still the region's biggest healthcare show — medical technology, imaging, diagnostics and hospital infrastructure.

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Send us your dates.

A WhatsApp message saying where and when, and we come back with what is actually available and what it costs.

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